

# Evaluating and validating Claude output — Official docs and gold-mine references

**Pair:** [evaluating-validating-output-principles.md](#)

**Course:** Associate · Module 3 · Evaluating and Validating Claude's Output

**Use this file when:** you need vendor verification guidance, product features for grounding, or primary sources.

## How to use this pack

1. Learn discernment, failure patterns, diligence thresholds, and format reliability from the **principles** pair first.
2. Open this file for official Anthropic reduce-hallucination and verification pages.
3. Re-fetch product pages. Course notes cite behavior as of mid-2026. Labels move.

## Official product / standard docs

| Link                                                                   | What it teaches (mechanism)                                                                | Operator so-what                                                                             |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <a href="#">Reduce hallucinations (Claude Platform)</a>                | Allow uncertainty, ground in quotes, verify with citations                                 | Maps 1:1 to course prompt habits. Paste techniques into high-stakes prompts.                 |
| <a href="#">Reduce hallucinations (docs.anthropic.com mirror path)</a> | Same guardrail guidance on docs host                                                       | Bookmark both if one host renames paths.                                                     |
| <a href="#">Prompting best practices</a>                               | Clarity, structure, examples, verification patterns                                        | Pair with Module 2 components when building grounded prompts.                                |
| <a href="#">Claude Help Center (support.claude.com)</a>                | Product help including code execution and Excel-related citation features (re-fetch names) | Confirm which plan has code execution and spreadsheet cite behavior before you depend on it. |
| <a href="#">Build with Claude / Academy hub</a>                        | Entry to learning and platform practice                                                    | Course-adjacent path into current docs.                                                      |

## Course-named sources (verify live):

- AI Fluency Framework: **Discernment** and **Diligence** competencies (behavioral indicators).
- Claude product: code execution and cell-level citations where offered.

## Gold-mine first-principles sources

| Link                                                                                | Why gold                                                             | Extra tip from that source                                                                                 |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <a href="#">Effective context engineering for AI agents (Anthropic Engineering)</a> | Context vs prompt engineering: what sits in the window drives errors | Completeness and source-restriction fail when noise or missing files dominate context.                     |
| <a href="#">Equipping agents for the real world with Agent Skills</a>               | Procedure packs reduce variance                                      | Encode your do-not-ship checklist and verification prompts as a Skill so review does not depend on memory. |

| Link                                   | Why gold                                         | Extra tip from that source                                                                   |
|----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <a href="#">PortSwigger Research</a>   | Evidence-first security writeups                 | Same bar as course: claim needs method and evidence, not fluent narrative.                   |
| <a href="#">Simon Willison on LLMs</a> | Clear writing on evals, tools, and failure modes | Treat "capability hallucination" like any other false tool success: verify outside the chat. |

## Cross-stack / cross-vendor map

| Principle here                                     | Same idea elsewhere                                                         |
|----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Three references (requirements, source, standards) | Acceptance criteria + evidence + field convention in any eng/review process |
| Permit uncertainty                                 | "Refuse when unknown" system rules across vendors                           |
| Source restriction                                 | RAG with "answer only from retrieved chunks"                                |
| Auditable citations                                | Quote + pointer (page, clause, cell)                                        |
| Code execution for numbers                         | Tool-using agents, notebooks, spreadsheet formulas                          |
| Human override thresholds                          | Change control / dual control in ops and security                           |
| Capability hallucination                           | Fake tool success in any agent UI                                           |

## Suggested read order

1. Principles pair (this module)
2. [Reduce hallucinations](#)
3. [Prompting best practices](#)
4. Current Help Center pages for code execution / spreadsheet citations
5. Context engineering essay when outputs keep missing the hard file

## Gaps

| Missing source                                                         | Why it matters                            | Status                                                            |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Authenticated CPN Module 3 exercise "Triage the Output Set" full items | Exact self-assessment items               | gap — use operator triage card in principles until captured       |
| Stable public URL for AI Fluency Framework PDF                         | Exam language for Discernment / Diligence | gap — re-fetch from Anthropic learn / fluency pages at study time |
| Live plan matrix for code execution                                    | Feature availability by plan              | gap — check support.claude.com before relying                     |

## Do not put here

- Full re-teach of discernment protocol (principles pair)
- Orphan tips with no source row